



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Operations

APPAREL AND ACCESSORIES MARKETING EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain routine security precautions.
2. Explain employee's role in expense control.
3. Explain the nature of overhead/operating costs.
4. Process returns/exchanges.
5. Interpret business policies to customers/clients.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the ASSISTANT STORE MANAGER at VELVET & VINE, a fast-fashion retail chain that sells trendy apparel and accessories to young adults. The STORE MANAGER (judge) wants you to develop an operational plan to reduce the store's rising inventory shrinkage rate.

VELVET & VINE offers a wide product mix including denim, graphic tees, jewelry, and handbags. While sales revenue has increased by 10% over the last year, the store's profit margin has decreased. A recent audit revealed that the store's "shrinkage"—the difference between the inventory the store should have and what is physically in the store—has hit an all-time high of 4.5%. This loss is attributed to a combination of shoplifting, employee theft, and administrative paperwork errors.

The STORE MANAGER (judge) is concerned because the district office has stated that if shrinkage does not drop below 2% by the next quarter, payroll hours for the staff will be cut to cover the losses. This would result in fewer employees on the sales floor, which could negatively impact customer service.

The STORE MANAGER (judge) wants you to present a "Loss Prevention Action Plan" that addresses three specific areas:

1. Physical Security: How to deter external theft (shoplifting) in high-risk areas like fitting rooms and accessory displays.
2. Internal Procedures: How to reduce employee error at the point of sale and the receiving dock.
3. Culture: How to train employees to recognize their role in expense control and preventing loss without creating a hostile work environment.

You will present your ideas to the STORE MANAGER (judge) in a role-play to take place in the manager's office. The manager will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your plan to protect the store's assets.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How can we spot internal employee theft without making our honest employees feel like we don't trust them?
2. How does better customer service actually help prevent shoplifting?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain routine security precautions?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Explain employee's role in expense control?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Explain the nature of overhead/operating costs?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Process returns/exchanges?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Interpret business policies to customers/clients?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						